start.md | positioning.md | maps.md | pop-pod.md | pov.md | sources.md | +

duolingo.md / brand-positioning / assignment-2

rutgers-uni competitors research sources



Duolingo — What do we own?

Choosing the path.

01
Positioning
the statement

02
Maps
four sets of axes

03
POP / POD
and archetype

04
Point of view
the sacrifice

AI in Marketing, Assignment 2 · Cindy Ha

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rutgers-uni | competitors | research | sources

PART A

We win the ten-minute window, not the fluency race

For Gen Z learners brushing up on a language for travel, curiosity, or fun, Duolingo is the language-learning app that turns spare minutes into real progress, because its free, bite-sized lessons fit into any routine.

ONE TARGET

Gen Z casual learners

ONE BENEFIT

Spare minutes → progress

ONE REASON

Free, bite-sized, flexible

PART B

Being liked separates no one. Depth is bought.

PRICE × SATISFACTION



App-store ratings, retrieved September 2026

PRICE × FLUENCY OUTCOME



Public pricing and CEFR course data, September 2026

PART B

COMMITMENT × METHOD

Everyone else asks something of your day

Duolingo sits in the corner that needs neither a schedule nor another person. Even the casual-feeling options, like language exchange and on-demand tutors, still require a second human to show up.



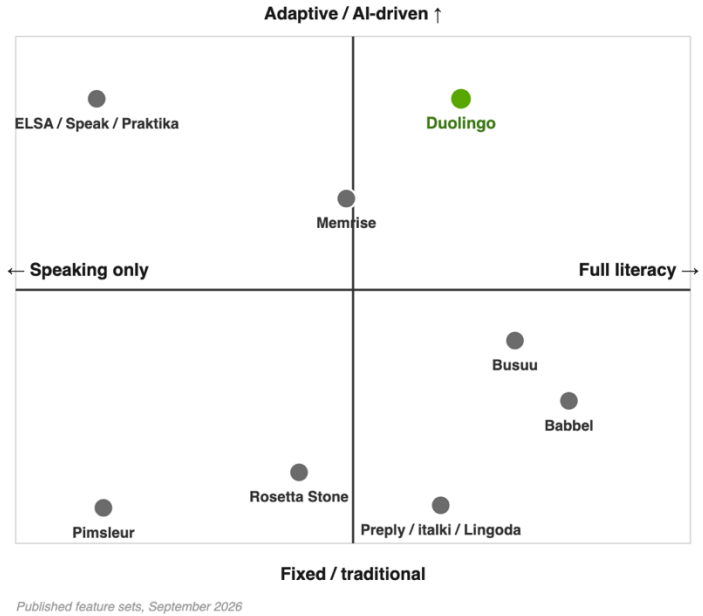
Product model and delivery format, September 2026

PART B

MODALITY × TECHNOLOGY

The most human option is the least adaptive

A tutor decides what comes next; an algorithm already knows. Duolingo is broad in modality and adaptive in method — a corner that the premium, human-led options structurally cannot reach.



Published feature sets, September 2026

PART B

The axes are the game

WHICH MAP REVEALS THE OPENING

Commitment × Method.

It is the only map where Duolingo occupies an empty corner rather than a crowded or unflattering one. Price puts it in a budget cluster; satisfaction puts everyone in the same band. Friction isolates the one thing Duolingo asks less of than anyone: your time, your calendar, and another person's attendance.

WHAT THE OBVIOUS AXIS HID

Premium buys depth with your time, not just money.

Price vs. quality said only that Duolingo is cheap and shallow. The technology axis showed the opposite of what price implied: live tutoring — the costliest, most human option — is the least adaptive thing in the category, because a person, not an algorithm, decides what you practice next.

PART C

Table stakes are crowded. Friction is not.

POINTS OF PARITY

- CEFR-aligned curriculum to B2
- 40+ languages
- Polished app, 4.6–4.8 ratings
- Speaking and listening practice

POINT OF DIFFERENCE

Zero friction to start and sustain

Free, self-paced, no schedule and no second person — while most rivals require at least one of the three.

Archetype: Everyman, with a Jester voice

PART D

Own the ten-minute window. Give up the fluency race.

Duolingo should own the moment a language has to fit into a life not built around it — ten minutes on a train, between classes, the week before a trip. Nothing to book, no one to meet, nothing to pay. Depth stays available all the way to B2 for anyone who wants it, but it is never the price of entry.

WHAT WE GIVE UP

The deadline learner

Fluency for a job, a visa, an exam

The premium tier

The $15–100/mo revenue that follows them

The credential

We are not the proof-of-proficiency brand

APPENDIX

Sources

PRICING & TIERS

· Duolingo plans (Super, Max, Family)
· Babbel pricing breakdown
· Rosetta Stone pricing breakdown
· italki vs Preply per-lesson rates

COMPETITOR POSITIONING

· Preply: human-led, AI-enabled
· Preply company profile
· Duolingo satisfaction themes

OUTCOMES & CURRICULUM

· Spanish course: 974 units, Intro–B2
· Duolingo CEFR alignment
· User-reported strengths and ceiling
· Category ratings band (4.6–4.8)

AI DISCLOSURE

· Researched and drafted with Claude (Anthropic).
· Models used: Sonnet 5, Opus 5

Indicative axis placements reflect market perception and published product models, not tested learning outcomes.